2026 RELOCATION GUIDE



YOUR PLAYBOOK FOR

Moving to Dallas–Fort Worth

The money, the areas and the move, in 12 quick pages.

KK

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SCAN FOR THE SITE

DFW by the numbers

Six numbers that explain most of what's different about buying here.

$0

State income tax

Texas doesn't tax your paycheck. It funds schools and cities with property taxes instead.

1.6–2.2%

Property tax rate, per year

Of the home's appraised value, depending on city and school district.

$358K

Typical DFW home value

Down 2% from a year ago. Suburbs north of Dallas run higher.

6.2 mo

Supply of homes for sale

More than 6 months leans toward buyers: more choice and more room to negotiate.

$3,489

Avg. home insurance, per year

Texas average in 2025, nearly double 2016, mostly from hail and wind.

30 mi

Downtown Dallas to Fort Worth

DFW is a dozen-plus cities, not one. Where you live sets your commute and taxes.

Sources: Zillow Research, Sept. 2026 (home value, supply); Republic Title 2025 DFW tax rates; Texas Department of Insurance, 2025.

The four sides of DFW

Most people pick a side first, then a neighborhood.

NORTH SUBURBS

Newest homes, corporate campuses, toll roads

Plano · Frisco · McKinney · Allen · Prosper · Celina · Richardson

FORT WORTH SIDE

Laid-back city, Western roots

Fort Worth · Arlington · Southlake · Grapevine · Flower Mound



DFW Airport
right in the middle

DALLAS

City living, older character homes

Uptown · East Dallas · Oak Cliff · Park Cities

EAST & LAKES

Lake life, more home for the money

Rockwall · Rowlett · Wylie

Narrow it down with three questions

1. **Where's work?** Your commute rules everything here.
2. **How long a drive?** 20 minutes or 45 opens very different areas.
3. **New or character?** New builds are north; older homes are close-in.

Which area fits you?

Find what matters most to you, then follow the dots across.

● Great fit ○ Good fit

If you want…	Uptown & E. Dallas	Richard-son	Plano	Frisco	McKinney	Prosper & Celina	FW Near Southside	Grapevine & Flower Mound
Walk to restaurants & shops	●		○		○		●	○
Brand-new construction				●	○	●		
Quick drive to downtown Dallas	●	○						
Close to DFW Airport								●
Near big corporate job hubs	○	○	●	●				
Historic homes & character	●				●		●	○
Bigger lots						●		○
Typical home value	Varies	$437K	$498K	$640K	$473K	$512K–760K	Varies	$549K–600K

Schools are assigned by address, not by city. Check the exact district for any home you like on the site's Schools page.

Typical values: each city's Zillow home value, Sept. 2026. "Varies" means the citywide number doesn't describe that neighborhood. The website has 40 area profiles.

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Close-in & the big suburbs



Uptown & East Dallas

Varies

Best for: city living

- Walk to restaurants, Katy Trail and Klyde Warren Park
- Condos and townhomes in Uptown
- 1920s–1950s homes near White Rock Lake



Richardson

$437K

Best for: close-in value

- DART rail into downtown Dallas
- Telecom Corridor and CityLine jobs
- 1960s–1980s ranch homes, mature trees



Plano

$498K

Best for: an established suburb

- Legacy West offices, shops and dining
- Big parks and trails like Arbor Hills
- Mostly 1980s–2000s homes



Frisco

$640K

Best for: newer homes & amenities

- The Star, PGA Frisco and pro soccer
- Mostly 2000s and newer, master-planned
- Dallas North Tollway and SH 121

Values: typical home value for the city, Zillow, Sept. 2026.

Growing north & the west side



McKinney

$473K

Best for: old charm plus new builds

- Historic downtown square
- Older homes near the square
- New neighborhoods to the north and west



Prosper & Celina

$512K–760K

Best for: brand-new & more space

- Some of DFW's newest neighborhoods
- Bigger lots and a small-town feel
- Ask about MUD and PID taxes



Fort Worth: Near Southside

Varies

Best for: laid-back city life

- Magnolia Avenue restaurants
- Bungalows in historic Fairmount
- Near downtown Fort Worth and TCU



Grapevine & Flower Mound

$549K–600K

Best for: frequent flyers

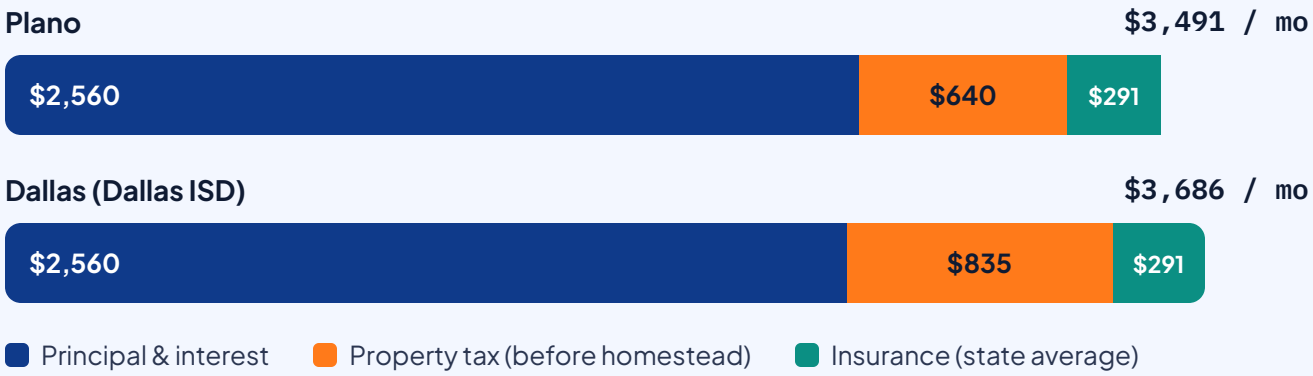
- Next door to DFW Airport
- Historic Main Street and Grapevine Lake
- Larger lots in Flower Mound

Values: typical home value for the city, Zillow, Sept. 2026. Ranges cover the two cities in a card.

Budget the payment, not the price

Taxes and insurance add about $900–$1,100 a month on a typical DFW home.

Example: $450,000 home, 10% down, 6.5% rate



Not included: HOA dues and mortgage insurance. Rates change daily; your lender gives the real number.

Four money moves

File your homestead

Takes $140,000 off your school-tax value. File with the county right after closing.

Quote insurance early

Get a quote before you offer. An older roof can raise the price a lot.

Ask about HOA, MUD, PID

Newer areas often add HOA dues or a utility-district tax. Ask on every home.

Plan for the extras

PMI under 20% down, and sales tax up to 8.25% on what you buy.

Tax: 2025 combined rates, Plano 1.71% and Dallas 2.23% (Republic Title). Insurance: Texas average $3,489 a year, 2025 (Texas Dept. of Insurance).

Texas homes 101

Clay soil and spring hail shape almost everything an inspector checks.

Slab foundations

- Some movement is normal
- Watch for sticking doors and wall cracks
- Ask for repair records and warranties

Roofs & hail

- Ask the roof's age
- Ask about past hail claims
- Older roofs cost more to insure

No basements

- Storage lives in the garage and attic
- Some new homes add a safe room

Watering rules

- Many cities limit sprinkler days
- Even moisture helps protect the foundation

Pools are common

- Budget for upkeep
- Expect higher insurance

New vs. resale

- Builders offer rate buydowns and credits
- Smaller lots, often a MUD or HOA
- Builder sales staff work for the builder

Tip Always get a full inspection during your option period, even on brand-new homes. In DFW, add a foundation check and a roof check.

07 · THE PROCESS

How buying works in Texas

Standard state forms, a title company and no attorney needed at closing.

1. **Get pre-approved**
   With a Texas lender, so your budget includes taxes.
2. **Sign a buyer agreement**
   Required before touring. It spells out what your agent does and how they're paid.
3. **Make an offer**
   On the TREC contract: price, closing date, option period, earnest money.
4. **The option period** THE TEXAS DIFFERENCE
   Pay a small fee to the seller for usually 5–10 days to inspect and back out for any reason. After it ends, walking away can cost your earnest money.
5. **Inspect & negotiate**
   Ask for repairs or a credit, or walk away.
6. **Appraisal, survey & title**
   Lender appraises, title company clears ownership, survey shows the lot lines.
7. **Close & get keys**
   Sign at the title company. Keys once the loan funds.
8. **File your homestead**
   With your county appraisal district, right after closing.

Good to know: Texas is a non-disclosure state, so sale prices aren't public. The right offer comes from your agent's sales data, not a website estimate.

Your move checklist

30 **days** after you move to register your car in Texas

90 **days** after you move to get a Texas driver license

90 days out
PLAN

- [ ] Call Kohl; set must-haves
- [ ] Decide: buy now or rent first
- [ ] Get pre-approved
- [ ] Check school districts

60 days out
LOOK

- [ ] 2–3 day house-hunting trip
- [ ] Get insurance quotes
- [ ] Or tour by live video
- [ ] Book movers early

30 days out
SET UP

- [ ] Lock closing or lease date
- [ ] Water, trash and internet
- [ ] Pick electricity at PowerToChoose.org
- [ ] Order an NTTA TollTag

First 30 days
SETTLE IN

- [ ] File your homestead
- [ ] Register at the county tax office
- [ ] Emissions test for your car
- [ ] Book a DPS license appointment

First 90 days
FINISH

- [ ] Get your Texas driver license
- [ ] Update your address everywhere
- [ ] Register to vote
- [ ] Find a doctor, dentist and vet

Car rules: TxDMV "New to Texas." Emissions tests apply in Dallas, Collin, Denton, Tarrant, Rockwall and other listed counties. Garland and Denton run their own electric utilities.

Weather & getting around

THE WEATHER

~100°F
Long, hot summers
June–Sept. Look for shade trees, good insulation and a newer A/C.

Mar–Jun
Storm season
Hail and tornado warnings. Sirens mean an inside room, lowest floor.

A few days
Ice, not snow
Rare, but roads and schools often close when it hits.

GETTING AROUND

2 big airports	DFW International, a hub for American Airlines, and Dallas Love Field, home of Southwest.
Toll roads	Dallas North Tollway, Bush Turnpike and Sam Rayburn are the fast routes north. A TollTag beats pay-by-mail.
Trains	DART light rail, the TRE between downtown Dallas and Fort Worth, and the Silver Line to DFW Airport. Most people still drive.
Game days	Cowboys, Rangers, Mavericks, Stars, FC Dallas and the Wings.

Not sure yet? Rent first.

A 3–6 month rental lets you learn the commutes before you commit. Ask about break-lease terms so buying early doesn't mean two payments.

I can help here too. My company, Klaus Property Group, manages furnished mid-term rentals in Dallas.

10 · NEXT STEP

Let's find your spot

A 20-minute call narrows DFW to two or three areas that fit your life and budget. Call before your house-hunting trip, even if you're months away.

1
Intro call
Work, timing, budget

2
Short list
Areas and homes with real monthly costs

3
Tour
In person or by live video

4
Offer to keys
I handle every step

Send me before we talk

- [ ] Your work address
- [ ] Target move date
- [ ] Price range or pre-approval
- [ ] Your top 3 must-haves

Free on the website

40 area profiles

What can I afford? (Texas taxes included)

Schools by area

An AI assistant for any DFW question

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Scan for every neighborhood, school district and market number, plus an AI assistant on The Dallas Real Estate Internet.

Texas law requires these notices: Information About Brokerage Services and Consumer Protection Notice, at trec.texas.gov. Figures checked October 2026; not an appraisal. Photos: R K, Nancy Jo Lambert, adam roye (Unsplash); Koushalya Karthikeyan (Pexels); Andreas Praefcke (CC BY 3.0), Michael Barera (CC BY-SA 4.0), Nicolas Henderson (CC BY 2.0), Renelibrary (CC BY-SA 4.0), diego_bf109 (CC BY-SA 2.0), via Wikimedia Commons.